

zepto

BRAND EQUITY & POSITIONING AUDIT

**Quick commerce turned
speed into a commodity.**

Zepto must now own convenience.

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Zepto's equity audit — the story at a glance

01

The service works.

Execution is Zepto's strongest asset.

Order accuracy 90%. Post-delivery satisfaction 3.81/5. Delivery promise largely kept. Zepto has built a reliable machine.

02

The brand trails.

Blinkit is recalled first. Zepto is considered second.

In unaided recall for '10-min delivery', Blinkit wins 51% vs. Zepto 29%. When price is equal, they near-tie - but memory disadvantage matters.

03

Loyalty is fragile.

Customers use Zepto. They don't defend it.

46% would switch for a ₹30 discount. Only 5% call themselves unconditionally loyal. Active engagement lowest score: 2.42/5.

04

The solution is meaning.

Speed earned attention. Convenience must earn loyalty.

Zepto's next chapter: evolve from the fastest app to the most indispensable one. Platform: 'Life At Your Fingertips.'

Consumers stopped buying groceries.

They started buying time.

Quick commerce reframed the category from product delivery to friction elimination.



CATEGORY INSIGHT

The real purchase in quick commerce is not the product - it is the elimination of planning, effort, and waiting.

₹12,000Cr+

India Q-Commerce GMV

45%

YoY growth

500M+

Orders / year

Zepto built a category-defining machine.

In 3 years, two IIT dropouts rewired urban India's relationship with convenience.

01

The Problem

Urban professionals had no fast, reliable way to get household essentials delivered. BigBasket required 24-hour notice.

02

The Insight

Dense Indian metros made 2km-radius dark stores economically viable. 10-minute delivery was technically achievable.

03

The Machine

App-first ordering + hyperlocal dark stores + 200–500 focused SKUs = category disruption.

₹14,000Cr+

Gross Merchandise Value (FY25)

700+

Dark Stores across India

8–10 min

Actual delivery time

\$1.4B

Valuation (2024)



10-minute delivery is now table stakes.

When every competitor makes the same promise, speed stops being a differentiator and starts being an entry requirement.

Every major player now promises instant delivery:

Blinkit

10–12 min, Zomato distribution, 800+ dark stores

Swiggy Instamart

15–20 min, bundled with food delivery

Flipkart Minutes

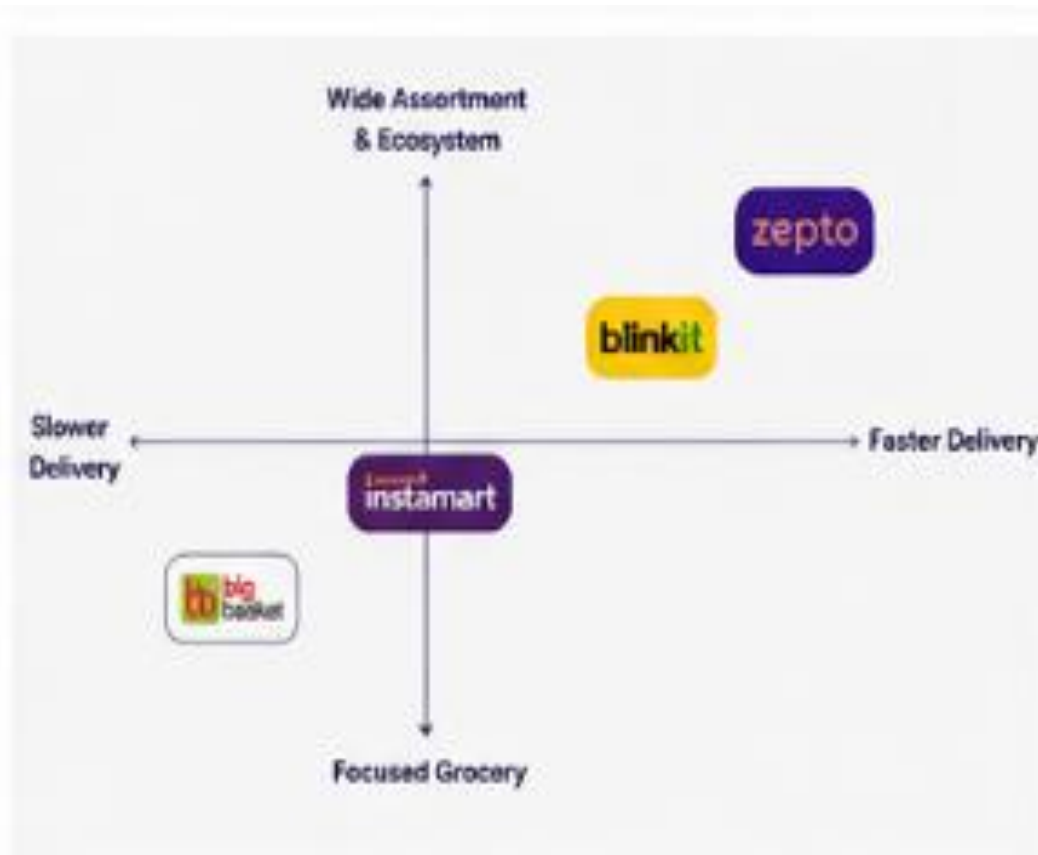
10 min, Walmart supply chain backing

JioMart

30 min, Reliance retail scale

Speed is the mechanism. Convenience is the value.

Where Zepto competes - and where it must move.



Dimension	Zepto	Blinkit	Instamart
Delivery Speed	8–10 min ✓	10–12 min	15–20 min
Unaided Recall	29%	51%	5%
Price Perception	Budget-friendly	Moderate	Moderate+
Equal-price pref.	37% (survey)	39%	8%
Loyalty (1–5)	2.93	—	—
Brand Archetype	Hero+Caregiver	Jester	Caregiver

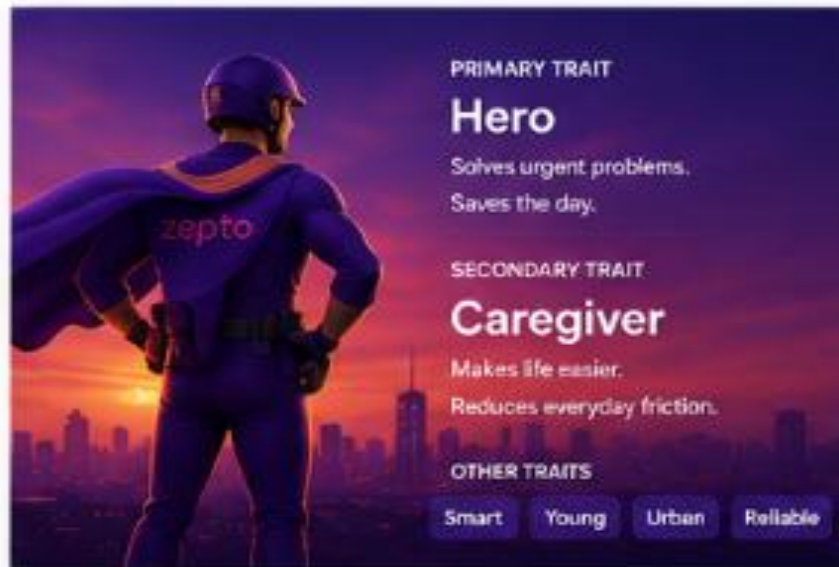
SO WHAT?

Zepto matches Blinkit on service delivery but trails it on the metric that drives impulse purchases: mental availability.

In a category driven by habit and immediacy, being recalled second means losing before the decision is made.

Zepto's identity is clear, not deep.

The brand communicates well. It does not yet connect emotionally.



WHAT THE BRAND SIGNALS



Speed

Name, logo, palette all encode speed and immediacy. Instantly legible.



Urban

All visual cues target 18–35 metro consumers. The brand feels right-sized for its audience.



Accessible

Blue + yellow connotes value and approachability — not premium, not cheap.



Tech-Native

App-first design language. Digital credibility baked into every touchpoint.



Missing

No warmth. No cultural story. No 'why'. The brand explains itself, but doesn't move people.

What consumers revealed about Zepto.

Key finding: At equal price, Zepto and Blinkit are statistically tied - the gap is in memory, not merit.

METHODOLOGY

Survey Type

Google Forms - Online

Sample Size

n = 59

Framework

Keller CBBE (adapted)

Questions

22 items

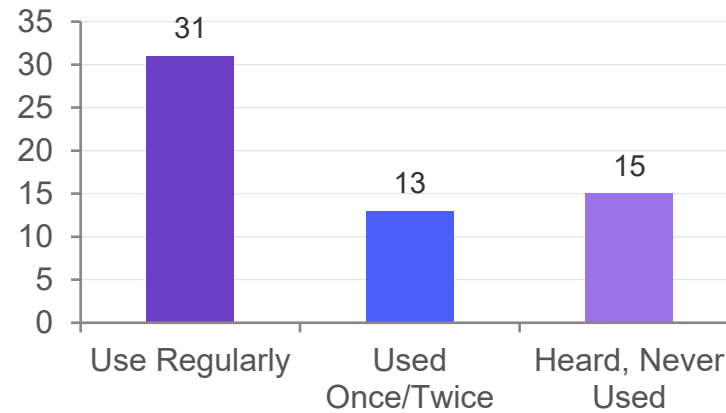
Familiarity Mix

53% regular · 22% tried once · 25% aware-only

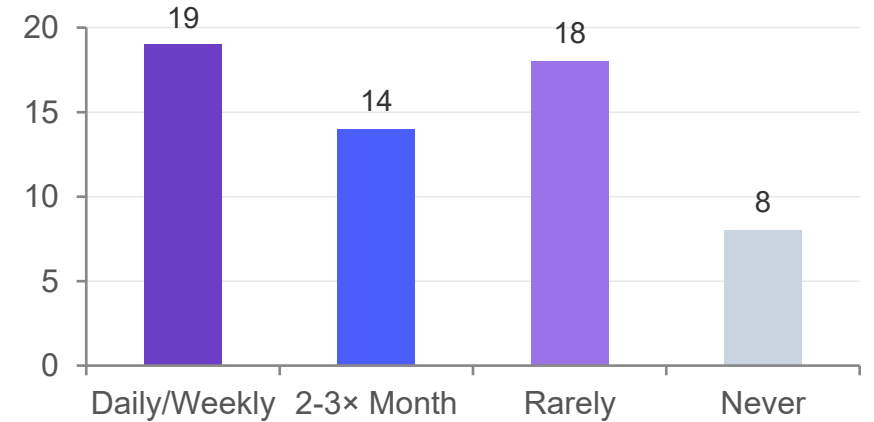
Cities

Urban metros — Raipur, Surat, Mumbai, Bengaluru

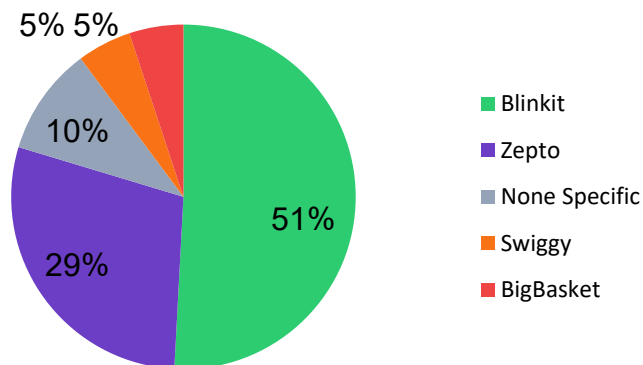
Brand Familiarity



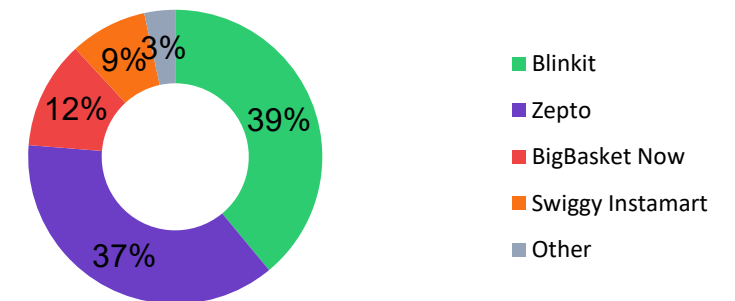
Order Frequency



'10-min Delivery' - Recalled First

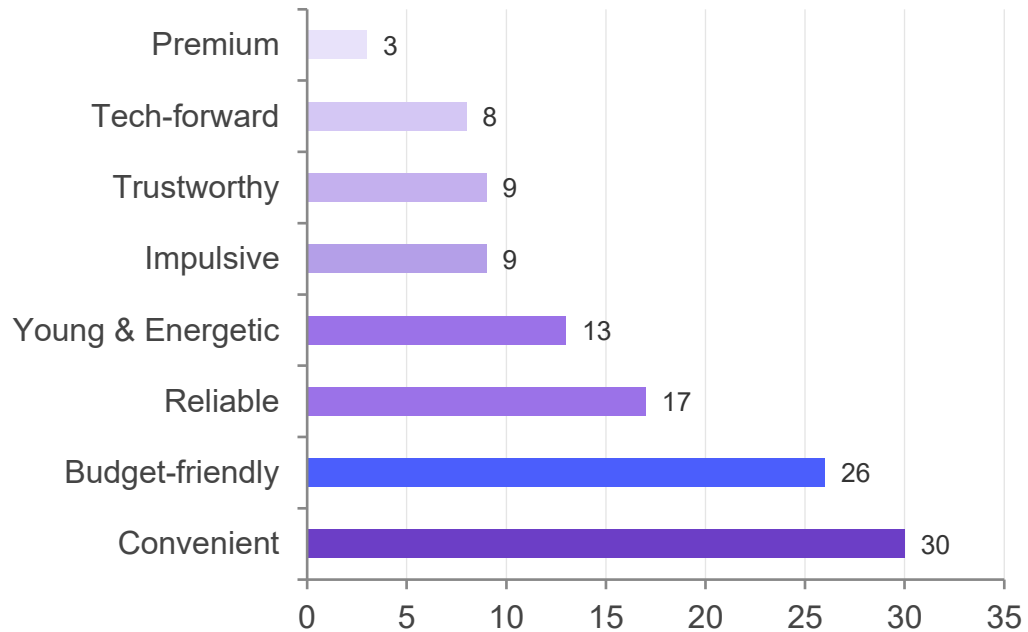


Preference at Equal Price (n=59)



Blinkit is recalled first. Zepto is considered second.

What consumers associate with Zepto (multi-select, n=59)



Who do consumers think Zepto is built for?



29%

Unaided recall
(‘10-min delivery’)

vs Blinkit 51%

53%

Regular users

51%

Associate ‘Convenient’

74%

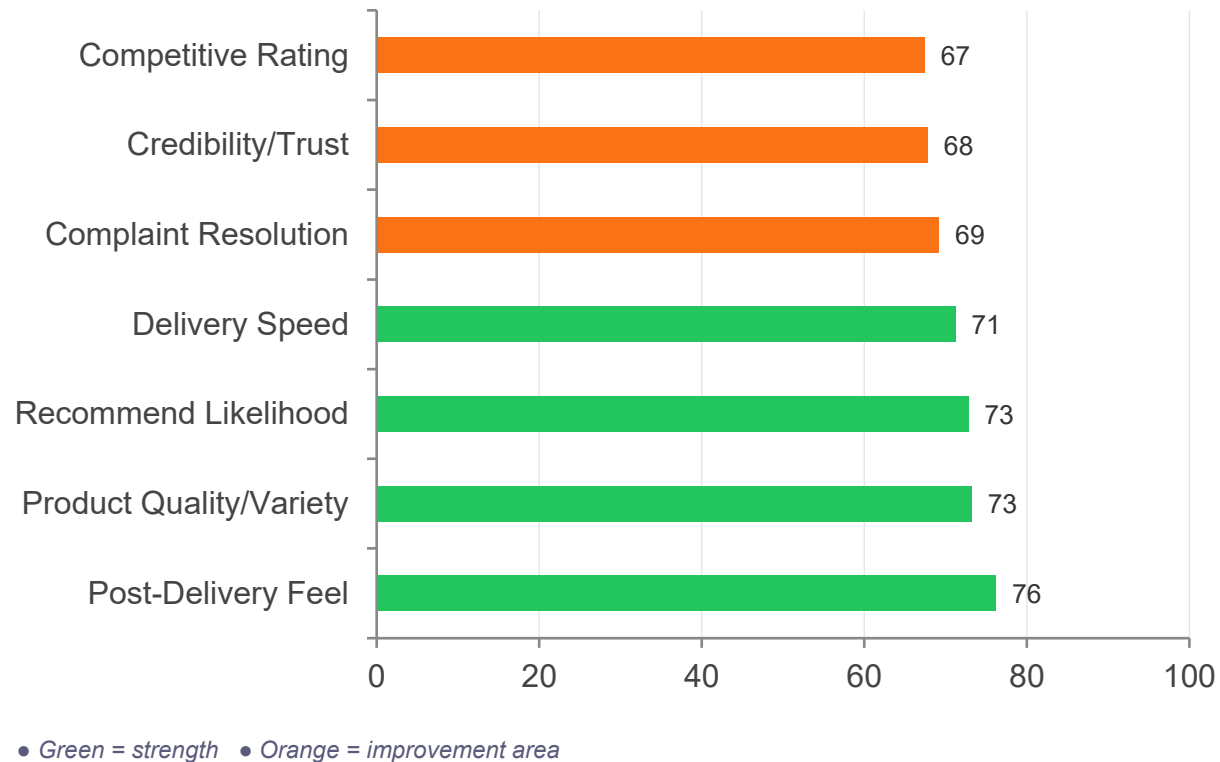
See it as mass-market
(‘for everyone’)

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION:

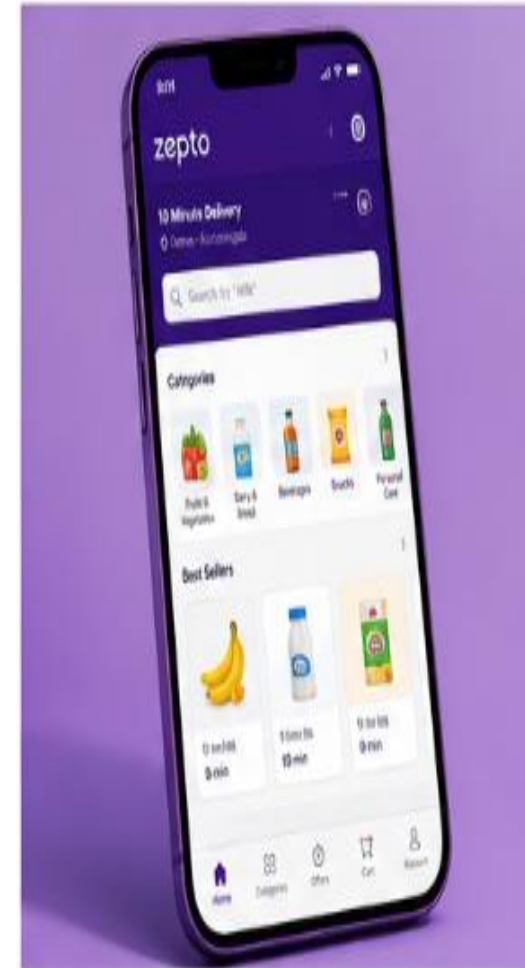
When customers think ‘quick commerce’, Blinkit enters memory first. In impulse-driven purchases, the first-recalled brand wins. Zepto must close this mental availability gap.

Execution is Zepto's strongest asset.

The service works. The brand needs to catch up.



90% of respondents strongly agree: Zepto delivers correct items and rarely cancels.



What the data says

90% Strongly Agree that Zepto delivers correct items. Post-delivery feel averages 3.81/5 — 'Satisfied' dominates.

Why it matters

Reliability is the minimum credible baseline for any app-based commerce brand. Zepto clears this bar convincingly.

Strategic implication

Service quality is necessary but not sufficient for brand equity. Reliability without emotional resonance creates usage, not loyalty.

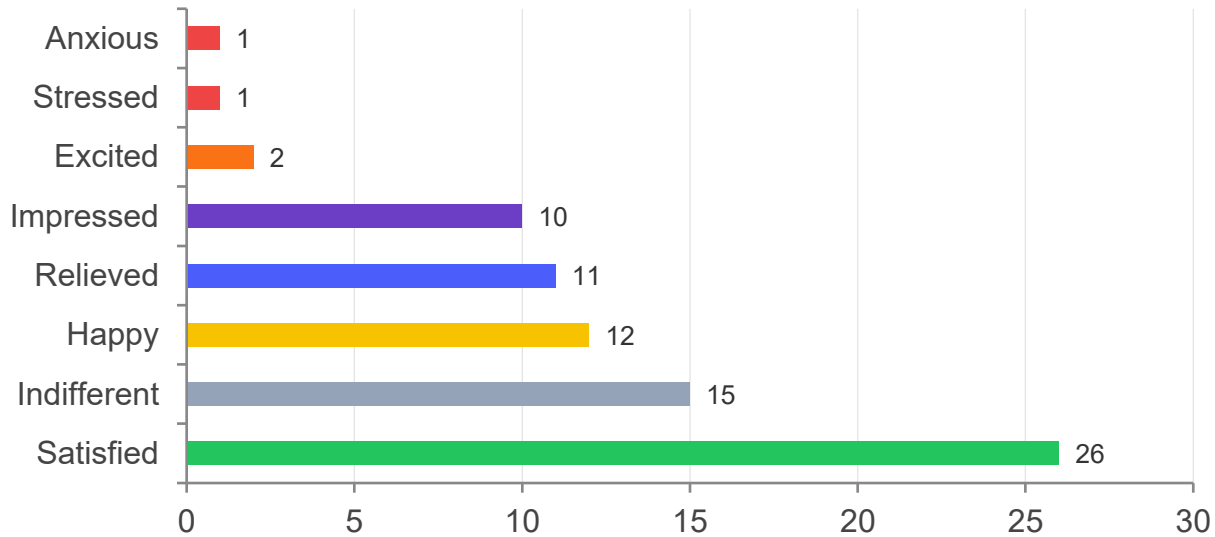
Fix this now

Complaint resolution (3.46/5) is the only true weakness. Immediate chat resolution < 2 min SLA would lift brand credibility.

Customers feel satisfied, not attached.

Zepto evokes functional satisfaction - not the emotional stickiness that builds brand loyalty.

Feelings experienced while using Zepto (multi-select)



Brand Identity Scores (/5)



WHAT

44% feel 'Satisfied' after delivery. Only 2 respondents feel 'Excited'. 25% feel 'Indifferent' - quarter of users are completely unmoved by the experience.

WHY IT MATTERS

'Satisfied' is the emotion of a utility, not a brand. Netflix creates excitement. Apple creates pride. Zepto creates satisfaction - the emotion of a solved errand.

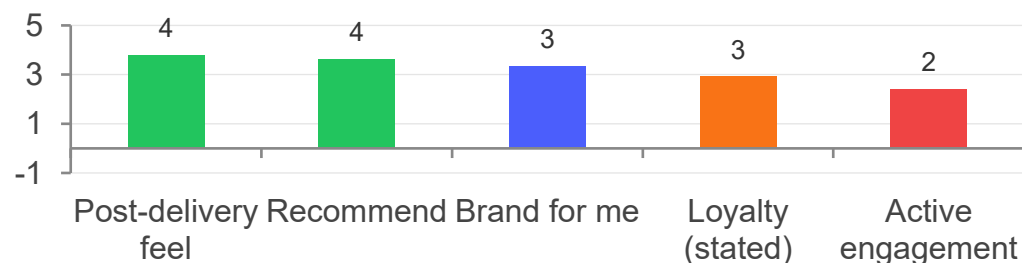
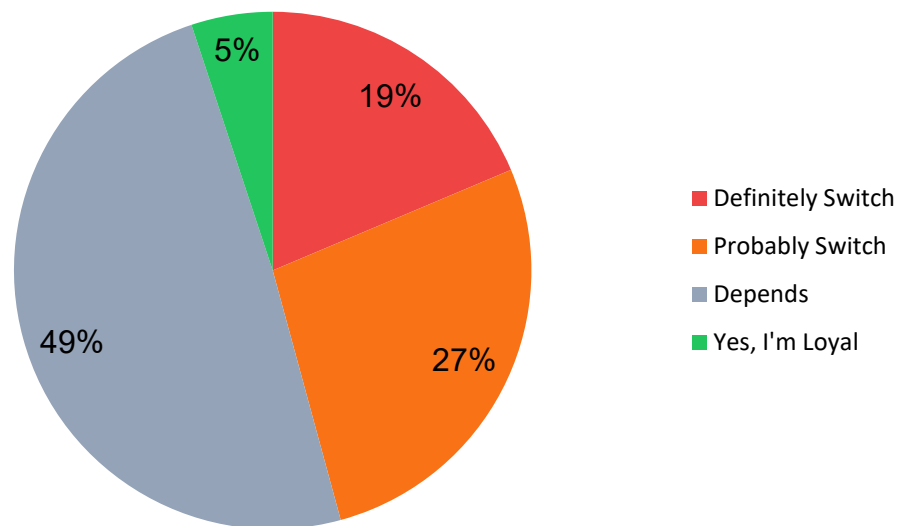
STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

Active engagement: 2.42/5 - the lowest score in the entire model. Consumers don't follow Zepto. They use it. Usage without emotional investment is vulnerable to any competitor offering a ₹30 discount.

Loyalty evaporates when discounts disappear.

Zepto has built usage frequency. It has not built brand attachment.

Loyalty under competitive pressure (₹30 discount scenario)



46%

would switch or probably switch for ₹30



5%

are unconditionally loyal ('Yes, I'm loyal')



2.42/5

active engagement - lowest in entire survey



2.93/5

stated loyalty - below neutral midpoint

Resonance = 48.5/100. The equity pyramid is weakest exactly where it needs to be strongest - at the top.

The equity pyramid is bottom-heavy.

Strong foundations - weak top. Performance without resonance is a brand at risk.



BRAND RESONANCE Customers use Zepto. They do not defend it.	CRITICAL	48.5
JUDGEMENT Zepto is trusted. It is not yet seen as superior.	WEAK	55.6
FEELING Satisfaction, not excitement. Utility, not affection.	WEAK	59.2
IMAGERY Modern brand image. Low emotional ownership.	FAIR	62.8
PERFORMANCE Execution is strong. This is the brand's anchor.	GOOD	65.3
BRAND SALIENCE Mass awareness. Blinkit is still top-of-mind.	FAIR	57.4

DIAGNOSIS

Four signals. One conclusion.

01

Performance is strong.

Score: 65.3 / 100. 90% order accuracy. Post-delivery satisfaction 3.81/5.

Zepto has built a reliable machine. The issue is not what it delivers - it's what it means.

02

Recall trails Blinkit.

Unaided recall: Zepto 29% vs. Blinkit 51%.

In impulse-driven categories, the first brand recalled wins the transaction. Zepto is losing unconsidered purchases before the app is even opened.

03

Preference vanishes under price pressure.

46% would switch for ₹30. Only 5% unconditionally loyal.

Zepto's competitive advantage is operational, not emotional. That makes it vulnerable to any competitor with deeper pockets or a promotional budget.

04

Engagement is shallow.

Active engagement: 2.42/5 - lowest score in the model.

Consumers don't follow Zepto's launches. They don't advocate for it. They use it the way they use a utility - reliably, invisibly, and without attachment.

CONCLUSION: Zepto has built a strong service - but not yet a defensible brand. The problem is not performance. The problem is meaning.

Where the brand stands. Where the opportunity lies.

STRENGTHS

- 90% order accuracy - reliability is the strongest functional asset
- App-first UX with low-friction 3-tap ordering; strong among 18–35 urban cohort
- 700+ dark stores deliver 8–10 min - one of India's most credible operations
- Zepto Café creates category expansion beyond grocery
- 'Budget-friendly' association (44%) captures price-sensitive metro consumers

OPPORTUNITIES

- ₹19,000Cr Q-commerce market growing 45% YoY - category is still early
- 44% 'maybe' on paying premium: convert with a Zepto Pass loyalty subscription
- Zepto Café expansion: food is the highest-frequency category; owns daily ritual
- Category expansion to beauty, gifting, health creates 'Life at Your Fingertips' positioning
- 'Everyone' brand perception (74%) is a mass-scale foundation if emotionally deepened

WEAKNESSES

- Blinkit's stronger mental availability limits Zepto's ability to convert operational superiority into preference
- Resonance 48.5/100 - consumers rely on Zepto but do not identify with it
- Complaint resolution (3.46/5) is the only true service weakness; erodes trust with power users
- Coverage gaps in Tier-2/3 cities limit total addressable market
- Active engagement 2.42/5 - zero community or emotional infrastructure

THREATS

- Blinkit's Zomato ecosystem integration creates distribution and cross-sell advantages Zepto cannot easily replicate
- Speed commoditisation: Swiggy Instamart, Flipkart Minutes, JioMart all at 10–15 min
- 46% price-elastic loyalty: a sustained ₹30 cashback war could drain Zepto's user base
- Rising CAC in tier-1 metros makes growth increasingly expensive without retention
- Reliance Retail's offline scale gives JioMart a structural cost advantage at GMV scale

S	W	O	T
STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES	OPPORTUNITIES	THREATS
• Strong awareness • Speed leadership • Memorable branding • App experience • Young audience connect	• Overdependence on speed • Limited emotional differentiation • High operating costs	• Lifestyle positioning • Category expansion • Membership ecosystem • Private label brands	• Blinkit • Instamart • Price wars • Delivery parity • Rising CAC

The issue is not performance. The issue is meaning.

CURRENT STATE

Fast delivery app.
Customers use it. Don't defend it.



FUTURE STATE

Life At Your Fingertips.
The brand people can't imagine life without.

FIVE SHIFTS TO GET THERE

Speed → Convenience

Position around life simplification, not delivery time

Transactional → Relational

Build Zepto Pass: loyalty, subscriptions, recurring value

Grocery → Lifestyle

Café, beauty, gifting, health - become a daily OS

Usage → Advocacy

Emotional moments that turn satisfied users into brand defenders

Utility → Identity

Make Zepto the brand that says 'I value my time' to the world



Five moves to build a brand people defend.

01 Fix the complaint experience immediately.

Immediate · 0–3 months

Instant chat resolution (< 2 min SLA). Proactive stockout notification. Refund confirmation within 60 seconds.

Every failed resolution creates a brand detractor. This is the cheapest win available.

02 Build emotional resonance through storytelling.

Short-term · 0–6 months

'Zepto Moments' campaign: delivery anniversaries, 50th-order milestones. Post-delivery UX micro-gratification. Make the transaction feel human.

Emotional moments create advocates. Advocates create word-of-mouth. WOM creates the salience that closes the Blinkit gap.

03 Launch Zepto Pass - convert the 44% 'maybe' segment.

Medium-term · 6–12 months

Subscription model: priority delivery, exclusive SKUs, free deliveries, personalised restocking nudges.

Subscription creates switching cost. Switching cost creates loyalty that no ₹30 cashback can dissolve.

04 Accelerate category expansion beyond grocery.

Medium-term · 6–18 months

Scale Zepto Café nationally. Add gifting, beauty, health, emergency verticals. Each new category = new usage occasion = new memory trigger.

Category breadth is the operational moat that speed no longer provides.

05 Reposition the brand platform to 'Life At Your Fingertips.'

Long-term · 12–24 months

New platform: 'Life At Your Fingertips.' Emotional tagline that connects across all categories and survives speed commoditisation.

This is the only sustainable moat: a brand people identify with, not just rely on.

"Life At Your Fingertips"

Zepto removes friction from every moment of urban life.

 Grocery

 Café

 Medicine

 Beauty

 Electronics

 Gifting

 Emergency

 Wellness

Why this wins: Consumers don't buy 10 minutes. They buy convenience · reliability · reduced effort · peace of mind · problem solving.



CLOSING ARGUMENT

Speed got Zepto noticed.

Meaning will make it chosen.

The engine is built.

The next chapter is turning a fast service into a brand people defend.

Group 01 · Scaler School of Business · PGP Cohort 2

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